Level 4 Adult ESL Curriculum · Lesson 13 (Week 14): My Story So Far

Status: Draft for review; not published.

Date: October 2026

Audience: Program coordinators and volunteer teachers

Companion files: images/ (12 vocabulary pictures + images/CREDITS.md). Listening audio: not recorded yet (coming soon); until then, read the listening script in this plan aloud.

> **Topic:** Personal growth and the graduation talk: learners look back at their own learning (when they started, what was hard, what they can do now) and look forward to the next step. They tell a short story with time clauses (*before / after / when*), past ability (*couldn't / was able to*), and the past continuous. Every story is the learner's choice; "my life in this class" is always enough. All names are invented.

How this lesson is organized

Part	What's inside	Who uses it
Teacher Plan	At a glance, clock-time plan, step-by-step boxes, listening script, answer key, teacher notes	Volunteer teachers
Student Pages	Opening Talk, New Words, My Words, Listening, Grammar, Talk Time, Homework, Read & Write, Exit Ticket, Task Words (optional). **Print this part for learners**	Learners
Picture Credits	Picture and license credits	Coordinators

What Lesson 13 builds on and what it adds

Before (review only)	Where	New in Level 4 Lesson 13
used to	Level 4 Lesson 2	*I used to stay home on weekends.*
present perfect	Level 4 Lessons 1 and 5	*I've made friends in this class.*
past continuous	Level 3	***I was working** at a restaurant when I met her.*

TEACHER PLAN

Lesson 13 (Week 14)

My Story So Far

At a glance · Clock-time plan · Step by step · Script and answer key

How to Use This Plan

You don't need to speak Spanish or any other language. Teach in English. Show, point, and gesture. Some Grammar pages have one short **contrast tip**, only where a common mix-up exists. Learners read it on their own. You never need to read, translate, or explain it.

Instructions: use the same short task words every week: *Listen. Circle. Check. Write. Work with a partner. Work in a group. Ask a follow-up question. Give a reason.* An optional Task Words page is at the back of the workbook for learners who want it.

Instruction rule: Model it (do it with one learner while everyone watches), **check it** (ask: "What can you do now that you couldn't do before? What's next?"), **then go**. Say less, show more.

Grouping toolkit: *Pairs:* turn to a neighbor; with an odd number, make one group of 3. *Groups:* 3–4 learners. *Inside–outside circles:* the inner circle faces out, the outer circle faces in; the outer circle moves one person to the right each round. *Mingle:* everyone stands and talks to many classmates. The teacher joins a pair only if one learner is left over.

When a learner is stuck or speaks another language to you: (1) show it: the picture, a gesture, or the board; (2) give one more short English example; (3) point to the grammar box on their page; (4) a classmate can help for a few seconds, then back to English. You don't need to understand what classmates say to each other.

Three sentences, not one: in Level 4, every Talk Time answer and every exit ticket has about three connected sentences: the answer, a reason, and a detail or example.

Lesson 13 (Week 14): My Story So Far

At a glance

Objectives: learners can…

- tell events in order with *before / after / when* and use a comma when the time clause comes first
- use the present after *when / after* for the future (*After I finish this class, I'll…*)
- talk about past ability with *couldn't / was able to*
- make a 5-event timeline of my learning and tell it to a group
- write an email (5–8 sentences) to my teacher about my story so far, the start of my graduation talk

Materials

- Student Pages for Lesson 13 (print for the number expected + 3 spares)
- Board and markers
- A timeline of your own learning on the board (5 events) for the model
- The feedback cards on the Talk Time page (copy and cut them, optional)
- A timer (phone)
- Listening: **no recording yet.** Read the listening script aloud (with a volunteer if you can), at a natural speed, two times.
- **Prep time:** 15 minutes (read the plan; practice reading the listening script; write your own 1-minute story to model).

Key vocabulary (with pictures on the New Words page)

★ milestone • ★ challenge • ★ succeed • ★ confident • ★ get used to • ★ make friends • ★ be able to • ★ support • ★ celebrate • ★ timeline • ★ speech • audience

Also: a step, a goal, a success, nervous, proud, advice, a graduation, a certificate, a talk, a shift.

Clock-time plan

Times are loose. If the listening or Talk Time runs long, take the time from Read & Write.

Time	Step	Min	Grouping (15 / 7–8)	If running behind
6:00–6:08	**Opening Talk + Homework Check**	8	Pairs (7 pairs + 1 trio / 3–4 pairs)	One card only
6:08–6:15	**New Words** (picture page) + pair game (+ My Words)	7	Whole class, then pairs	Teach the ★ words only
6:15–6:30	**Listening:** play 1 (Task A), play 2 (Tasks B and C) + "Hear it, say it"	15	Individuals, then pairs check	Do Task C together on the board
6:30–6:45	**Grammar Q&A:** *before / after / when* + pair check	15	Whole class, then pairs	Skip the pair check; Talk Time practices it
6:45–7:00	BREAK	15		
7:00–7:15	**Talk Time: Story Timeline + Talk Rehearsal**	15	Pairs, then groups of 3	Round 1 only
7:15–7:25	**Read & Write:** A learner story; an email to my teacher	10	Pairs read, then individual writing	Reading questions only; the writing becomes homework
7:25–7:30	**Exit Ticket + Homework**	5	Individuals	**Never skip**

> **Skip order if you're running behind:** (1) the Read & Write writing task (it becomes homework); (2) the pair check at the end of Grammar; (3) the second round of Talk Time. **Never skip:** the listening tasks, the grammar boxes and the mistakes table, and the exit ticket.

> **Attendance (15 → 7–8 → 5 or fewer):** every step lists the sizes. With 5 or fewer, each learner makes a timeline and tells it to the whole group; you give the feedback cards. Late arrivals make a 3-event timeline and listen in a group, then tell it.

Step by step

Step 1 · 6:00–6:08 · Opening Talk · 8 min

- **Grouping:** pairs, the same partner for both parts. 15 learners: 7 pairs + 1 group of 3. 7–8 learners: 3–4 pairs. 5 or fewer: pairs, or one group with you.
- **Before class:** write on the board: *who / that*; warning signs
- **Opening Talk (5 min):** learners open the **Opening Talk** page. A asks a card question; B answers in **3 sentences** (the answer, a reason, a detail); A asks one follow-up. Switch after each card.
- **Model with one learner:** you say, "Tell me one warning sign of a scam." The learner answers with *who / that* (*A caller who asks for gift cards.*). Then you ask, "What should you do?" Help them say 3 sentences.
- **Homework Check (3 min):** Pairs compare Homework item 1 (*who / that*) and read their 3 warning signs (item 3) to each other. Then they fill in the box on the Opening Talk page. Walk around. Write **2** common errors on the board (often *a man who he called* (→ *a man who called*) and *a text who said* (→ *a text that said*)) and correct them together. Also put up 2 corrections from last week's exit tickets.
- **Late arrivals:** join any pair as a group of 3.
- **If behind:** one card only.

Step 2 · 6:08–6:15 · New Words · 7 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs. Show the New Words page.
- **Do:** point to each picture and say the word. Learners repeat once.
- **Show the hard words:** *milestone* (an important step in your life); *challenge* (something hard); *succeed* (do it well, get what you wanted); *confident* (sure you can do it); *get used to* (something new becomes normal); *make friends*; *be able to* (can); *support* (help, be there for someone); *celebrate* (have a party, say "great job!"); *timeline* (events in order on a line); *speech* (a talk to many people); *audience* (the people who listen).
- **Check meaning (1 min):** ask "Is a challenge easy or hard?" (hard) • "When you are confident, are you sure or not sure?" (sure) • "Do you celebrate a milestone or a problem?" (a milestone).
- **Pairs (2 min):** A says a word; B points to the picture and makes a sentence (After I finish this class, I'll celebrate.). Switch. **15 learners:** finish with a quick team round (3 teams; you say a clue, the first team with the word gets a point). **7–8:** 2 teams. **5 or fewer:** one team against the clock.
- **My Words:** "Write any word you want in your language on the My Words page. It's your personal list. It's optional." Learners do it at home.
- **If behind:** teach the ★ words only.

Step 3 · 6:15–6:30 · Listening + "Hear it, say it" · 15 min

- **Grouping:** individuals, then pairs check. With 5 or fewer, check together as a group.
- **Before you listen (2 min):** say: "Mariana was a learner here. Now she is giving a short talk at graduation. Then her old teacher, Mr. Hill, asks her two questions. Listen: what is her main message?"
- **Play 1 → Task A** (the main idea). Pairs compare. Check together.
- **Read Tasks B and C together (1 min)** so learners know what to listen for.
- **Play 2 → Tasks B and C.** Pairs compare. Then show the answers (answer key).
- **"Hear it, say it" (3 min):** Point to the script line. *gonna* = going to: "I'm **going to** take a training class." Then practice the pause at the comma: *When I started, (pause) I couldn't understand the bus driver*. Stress the key words: *NOW I can…, NEXT…* The class repeats the two lines twice.
- **No recording yet:** read the script aloud with a volunteer (about 1:56), at a natural speed, two times. The script says *going to* and *want to*. People often say *gonna* and *wanna*; learners only need to recognize those words. When the audio is ready, it plays the conversation once; press play again for play 2. A third play is fine if the class needs it.
- **If behind:** do Task C together on the board, reading the lines yourself.

Step 4 · 6:30–6:45 · Grammar Q&A · 15 min

- **Grouping:** whole class, then pairs. Show the Grammar page. The **left side is the question. The right side is the answer.**
- **Show it (2 min):** draw a line on the board with 2 events: *I finished school.* → *I got a job.* Say, "**After I finished school,** I got a job." Point to the comma. Then: "I got a job **after I finished school.**" No comma. Then the future: "**After I finish this class, I'll** take Level 5." Cross out *When I will finish*.
- **The boxes (5 min):** Box 1: read across: *What did you do after you finished school?* → *After I finished school, I worked in a store.* Box 2: *couldn't / was able to*, past continuous. Box 3: the comma. Box 4: the talk frame.
- **Rule of thumb and Questions and answers (2 min):** read the rule of thumb aloud. Read each Q and A; the class reads the right sentence after you.
- **Check questions:** "Time clause first: comma or no comma?" (comma) • "*When I will finish* or *When I finish*?" (*When I finish*) • "Last month, *I could call* the clinic one time, or *I was able to call*?" (*I was able to call*).
- **Practice A and B (3 min):** learners write, then pairs check. Go over the answers. Read the Common mistakes table together: "Don't say… Say…".
- **Pair check (last 3 min):** A points to a picture and asks, "When did you **make friends** here?" B answers with a time clause: "**When I started** this class, I made friends." Switch. **15 learners:** swap partners once. **5 or fewer:** you join one pair.
- **If behind:** skip the pair check. Talk Time practices it.

Break · 6:45–7:00 · 15 min

- Write on the board: *When I started, I couldn't…* • *After I finished…, I…* • *Now I can…* • *After I finish this class, I'll…*

Step 5 · 7:00–7:15 · Talk Time: Story Timeline + Talk Rehearsal · 15 min

- **Model it first (1 min):** show your own 5-event timeline on the board and tell it in 1 minute: "When I started teaching, I was nervous. After I taught my first class, I felt better…" Then model a feedback card: "One thing I liked: your timeline was clear. One tip: speak a little slower."
- **Round 1 (7 min): Story Timeline (pairs).** Each learner writes 5 events from their own learning on the timeline (their choice; "my life in this class" is enough). They tell the timeline to a partner with *when / before / after*. The partner asks one question.
- **Round 2 (6 min): Talk Rehearsal (groups of 3).** Each learner tells their story (1–2 minutes) with the talk frame. The two listeners fill in a feedback card. Switch.
- **15 learners:** pairs; then groups of 3.
- **7–8 learners:** pairs; then groups of 3 (or 2 groups of 4).
- **5 or fewer:** each learner tells the whole group; you give the feedback cards.
- **Every answer needs a reason; every partner asks a follow-up.** Walk around and listen. Note 2 good sentences to praise and 1 common error for next week.
- **If behind:** round 1 only.

Step 6 · 7:15–7:25 · Read & Write: A learner story · 10 min

- **Grouping:** pairs read and answer; individual writing. With 5 or fewer, read the text aloud together.
- **Read (4 min):** Learners read the invented story on the Read & Write page, mark the time words, and answer the questions. Say: "Read fast first. Then find the answers." Pairs answer questions 1–5 together.
- **Check (1 min):** go over the answers (answer key).
- **Write (5 min):** Learners write an email (5–8 sentences) to their teacher about their story so far, with *when / before / after*. Show the example. This is the start of their graduation talk (Homework item 3). Learners start in class and finish at home (Homework item 2).
- **If behind:** questions 1–5 only; the writing becomes homework.

Step 7 · 7:25–7:30 · Exit Ticket + Homework · 5 min · NEVER SKIP

- **Exit ticket (3 min):** learners open the Exit Ticket page and answer in **3 sentences** with a reason: *Write about one change in your life.* Example on the board: *When I started this class, I couldn't talk on the phone in English. I was afraid to call the clinic. Now I can call by myself, because I practiced every week.* With 5 or fewer, a learner can say it to you first and then write it.
- **Collect the pages.** After class, sort them into ✓ / almost / not yet. Start next week with 2 corrections on the board (no names).
- **Homework (2 min):** open the Homework page. Do item 1 together (item 1: *after / I / finish / work, / I / come / to class (past) → After I finished work, I came to class.*). Say: "About 15–20 minutes. Finish your Read & Write writing at home."

Listening script (not recorded yet; about 1:56 when recorded; the conversation plays once, so press play again for the second listen)

Audio: the recording is coming soon. Until then, read the script aloud two times, with a volunteer if you can, at a natural, friendly speed. The script says *going to* and *want to*. People often say *gonna* and *wanna*; learners only need to recognize those words.

Narrator: Lesson thirteen. Mariana was a learner at this school. Now she is giving a short talk at graduation. Then her old teacher, Mr. Hill, asks her two questions.

Mariana: Good evening, everyone. My name is Mariana. When I started English classes here, I couldn't understand the bus driver. I was afraid to use the phone.

Mariana: The first year was hard. I had a night job at a restaurant, and I was tired. But my classmates helped me, and I made friends.

Mariana: After I finished Level 2, I got a new job at a hotel. Before I started that job, I practiced my interview with my teacher. Last year, I was able to call the clinic by myself for the first time. That was a big milestone for me.

Mariana: Now I can talk to guests at work, and I help my kids with their homework. I'm more confident.

Mariana: What is next for me? After I finish Level 5, I'm going to take a training class. I want a job at the front desk. My advice to you is simple. Come to class, and do not be afraid to make mistakes. Thank you for listening.

Mr. Hill: Thank you, Mariana. That was wonderful. Can I ask you two questions?

Mariana: Of course.

Mr. Hill: What was the biggest challenge for you?

Mariana: Getting used to the phone. When I called someone, I couldn't understand them very well. Now it's easy for me.

Mr. Hill: And what helped you the most?

Mariana: My classmates. When I was tired, they supported me. After class ended, we often studied together. And we celebrated every small success.

Mr. Hill: Thank you. Everyone, let's celebrate Mariana!

Narrator: That's the end of the listening.

Answer key

- *Listening Task A:* **a** (Come to class, and don't be afraid to make mistakes.).
- *Listening Task B:* 1 bus driver, 2 restaurant, 3 hotel, 4 clinic, 5 training class, 6 the phone.
- *Listening Task C:* 1 When, 2 After, 3 Before, 4 When, 5 When, 6 After.
- *Grammar Practice A:* 1 When, 2 couldn't, 3 will, 4 able, 5 working, 6 finish.
- *Grammar Practice B:* 1 finish, 2 After I finished school,, 3 couldn't, 4 was able to, 5 work, 6 made.
- *Talk Time:* answers will vary.

- *Homework 1:* 1 After I finished work, I came to class. 2 Before I started this job, I couldn't drive. 3 After I finish this class, I'll take Level 5. 4 Last month, I was able to call the clinic. *Homework 2 and 3:* answers will vary. *Homework 4:* 1 that, 2 who, 3 anyone, 4 mustn't, 5 that.
- *Read & Write B:* 1 He couldn't read the bus schedule. • 2 His neighbor told him. • 3 He came to class. • 4 He filled out a job application online. • 5 He's going to take a forklift training class. • *Writing (C):* answers will vary.
- *Exit ticket:* answers will vary. *A good answer:* "When I started this class, I couldn't talk on the phone in English. I was afraid to call the clinic. Now I can call by myself, because I practiced every week."

Teacher notes

- **Stories are the learner's choice.** "My life in this class" or "my job" is always enough. Never ask about migration journeys, family separation, or other hard events. If a learner shares something hard, thank them and move on.
- **Model first:** tell your own 1-minute story with the talk frame before learners start. Reading from paper is OK, today and at graduation.
- **Writing check 5 (the graduation talk):** the Read & Write email (5–8 sentences) is the first draft. Learners finish the full talk at home (Homework item 3, 12–15 sentences, about 2 minutes). Collect it next week and give one or two tips.
- **Next weeks:** Week 15 is the final exam; Week 16 is graduation, where learners can give their talk.
- **Pronunciation:** pause at the comma after a time clause: *When I started, (pause) I couldn't…*
- **Spanish and other languages:** the contrast tip on the Grammar page is optional. Learners read it on their own. You never need to read, translate, or explain it.
- **Reductions:** the listening says *going to*. People often say *gonna*. Learners only need to recognize it; they can always say the full form.

STUDENT WORKBOOK

Lesson 13 (Week 14)

My Story So Far

Opening Talk · New Words · Listening · Grammar · Talk Time · Homework · Read & Write · Exit Ticket

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Opening Talk

Name: _____ Date: _____

Work with a partner. A asks a question. B answers in 3 sentences: the answer, a reason, and a detail. A asks one follow-up question. Then switch.

A: What is one warning sign of a scam?	**A:** What should you do with a text that asks for your PIN?
A: Who can you call to check a bill?	**A:** Is it a scam? "You won a prize! Pay $20 to get it."

Follow-ups: **Why? • What should you do?**

Write your partner's name and one warning sign from Homework item 3.

My partner's name	Their warning sign and what to do

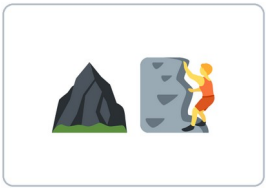
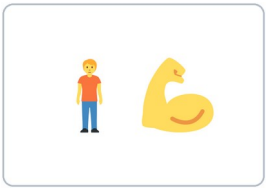
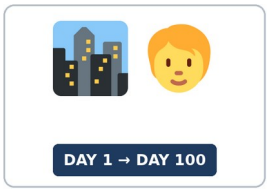
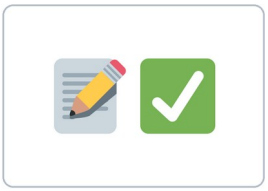
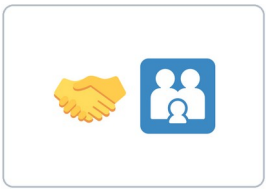
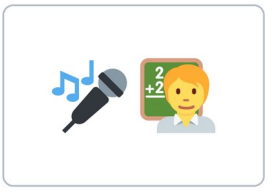
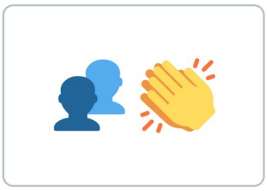
Lesson 13 (Week 14): My Story So Far

Student Page 1 · Week 14

Name: _____ Date: _____

New Words

Look. Listen. Repeat. ★ = most important words.

 ★ **milestone**	 ★ **challenge**	 ★ **succeed**	 ★ **confident**
 ★ **get used to**	 ★ **make friends**	 ★ **be able to**	 ★ **support**
 ★ **celebrate**	 ★ **timeline**	 ★ **speech**	 **audience**

Partner game: When did you…?

Example: A points to a picture and asks, "When did you **make friends** here?" B answers with a time clause: "**When I started** this class, I made friends." Switch.

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · My Words

My personal word list. Write each word in your language, if you want. Then write your own example.

Word	My language	My example
milestone		
challenge		
succeed		
confident		
get used to		
make friends		
be able to		
support		
celebrate		
timeline		
speech		
audience		

Add 2 more words from tonight (from the listening, the reading, or your partner).

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Listening

A former learner, Mariana, gives a short graduation talk about her learning: then, what was hard, now, and next. Her old teacher, Mr. Hill, asks her two questions.

A. Listen. What is Mariana's main message? Circle.

a. Come to class, and don't be afraid to make mistakes. **b.** Hotel jobs are easy. **c.** Level 5 is too hard.

B. Listen again. Her story in order: circle the answer.

1. First, when she started, she couldn't understand the (**bus driver** / **teacher**).
2. Then, in her first year, she worked at a (**restaurant** / **hotel**) at night.
3. After Level 2, she got a job at a (**hotel** / **clinic**).
4. Last year, she called the (**clinic** / **school**) by herself.
5. Next, after Level 5, she's going to take a (**training class** / **vacation**).
6. Her biggest challenge was (**the phone** / **the bus**).

C. Listen again. Write *before*, *after*, or *when*.

1. _____ I started English classes here, I couldn't understand the bus driver
2. _____ I finished Level 2, I got a new job at a hotel.
3. _____ I started that job, I practiced my interview with my teacher.
4. _____ I called someone, I couldn't understand them very well.
5. _____ I was tired, they supported me.
6. _____ class ended, we often studied together.

Hear it, say it

gonna = going to: "I'm **going to** take a training class." You can say *going to*. Listen for the short pause at the comma: *When I started, (pause) I couldn't…* Do the same in your talk. Stress the key words: *NOW I can…, NEXT…*

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Grammar

Read across. A reads from the left side. B answers from the right side. Choose one part from each column.

Grammar Box 1: *before / after / when*

QUESTION	
What did you do	after you finished school?
How did you feel	when you started this job?
What couldn't you do	before this class?
What will you do	after you finish this class?

ANSWER	
After I finished school,	I worked in a store.
When I started this job,	I didn't know anyone.
Before I started this class,	I couldn't fill out a form.
After I finish this class,	I'll take Level 5.

Grammar Box 2: *couldn't / was able to; was …ing*

QUESTION	
Could you	understand the bus driver?
Were you able to	call the clinic?
What were you doing	when you met your friend?

ANSWER	
No, I **couldn't**.	Now I **can**.
Yes, I **was able to**	call by myself last month.
I was working at a restaurant	**when** I met her.

Rule of thumb: *before / after / when* + a full sentence (*I started*, *I finished*). The time part can come **first** (with a comma) or **second** (no comma). For the future, use the present after *when / after / before*: ***After I finish this class, I'll take Level 5.***

Grammar Box 3: the comma

TIME PART FIRST: comma	TIME PART SECOND: no comma
When I started, I didn't know anyone.	*I didn't know anyone when I started.*
After I finish this class, I'll take Level 5.	*I'll take Level 5 after I finish this class.*

Grammar Box 4: the talk frame

PART	SAY
Then	*When I started…, I couldn't…*
What was hard	*It was hard because… But I've…*
Now	*Now I can… I'm more confident.*
Next	*After I finish…, I'll… because…*

Questions and answers

Q: *When I will finish* or *When I finish*?

A: ***When I finish this class, I'll take Level 5.*** Use the present after *when / after / before*, like after *if*.

Q: Do I need a comma?

A: Time part first: comma. ***After I finished school, I worked.*** Time part second: no comma. *I worked after I finished school.*

Q: *couldn't* or *wasn't able to*?

A: Both are OK: ***I couldn't drive. / I wasn't able to drive.*** For one success in the past, use *was able to*: *I was able to call the clinic.*

Practice A: Write one word.

1. _____ I started this job, I didn't know anyone.
2. Before I came here, I _____ speak English. (can't)
3. After I finish this class, I _____ take Level 5.
4. Last month, I was _____ to call the clinic by myself.
5. I was _____ at a store when I met my friend. (work)
6. When I _____ this class, I'll celebrate. (finish / will finish)

Practice B: Circle the correct words.

1. When I (**finish** / **will finish**) the class, I'll look for a new job.
2. (**After I finished school,** / **After I finished school**) I worked in a store.
3. Before I started class, I (**couldn't** / **can't**) read the bus schedule.
4. I (**was able to** / **could to**) fill out the form by myself.
5. I used to (**work** / **working**) at night, but now I work days.
6. I've (**made** / **make**) many friends in this class.

Common mistakes

✕ Don't say	✓ Say
When I will finish, I'll call you.	When I **finish**, I'll call you.
Before I came here I couldn't drive.	Before I came here**,** I couldn't drive.
I could to fill out the form.	I **was able to** fill out the form.
After finish class, I go home.	After **I finish** class, I go home.
I was work when I met her.	I was **working** when I met her.

> **Contrast tip (optional):** Spanish uses a special verb form after *cuando* for the future: *Cuando termine la clase, voy a celebrar.* English uses the simple present: ***When I finish*** *the class, I'm going to celebrate* (not *When I will finish*). What do you say in your language?

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Talk Time: Story Timeline

Round 1. Write 5 events from your learning on the timeline. It's your choice: your life in this class is enough. Then tell a partner with *when / before / after*. Your partner asks one question.

	When?	What happened?
1. Then	*When I started this class,*	
2.		
3.		
4. Now	*Now*	
5. Next	*After I finish this class,*	

Example: "When I started this class, I couldn't talk on the phone. After I practiced with my partner, I called the clinic. Last month, I was able to fill out a job form. Now I'm more confident. After I finish this class, I'll take Level 5."

QUESTIONS FOR YOUR PARTNER
What was the hardest part?
How did you feel when…?
What helped you?

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Talk Time: Talk Rehearsal

Round 2. Work in groups of 3. Tell your story (1–2 minutes) with the talk frame: Then → What was hard → Now → Next. The two listeners fill in a feedback card. Then switch.

TALK FRAME	
Then	*When I started…, I couldn't…*
What was hard	*It was hard because… But I've…*
Now	*Now I can…*
Next	*After I finish…, I'll… because…*

FEEDBACK CARD	Speaker:	Speaker:
One thing I liked		
One tip (*slower, louder, pause at the comma*)		

Remember: you can read from your paper. Look up at the audience at the end of each part.

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Homework

Homework (about 15–20 minutes). Bring it next week!

1. Write the sentence. Use a comma after the time part.

Example: when / I / start / this class, / I / not know / anyone (past) → *When I started this class, I didn't know anyone.*

1. after / I / finish / work, / I / come / to class (past) →

   _____

2. before / I / start / this job, / I / can't / drive (past) →

   _____

3. after / I / finish / this class, / I / take / Level 5 (future) →

   _____

4. last month, / I / be able to / call the clinic (past) →

   _____

2. Finish your writing from Read & Write C (your email). Read it one more time. Check ✓ the list in D.

☐ I finished it. ☐ I checked it with the list.

3. Finish your graduation talk (12–15 sentences, about 2 minutes). Start with your email from Read & Write. Bring it next week.

PART	My notes
Then (*When I started…*)	
What was hard (*It was hard because…*)	
Now (*Now I can…*)	
Next (*After I finish…, I'll…*)	

4. Review (Lesson 12). Write one word.

1. A scam is a trick _____ takes your money.
2. Don't trust a caller _____ asks for gift cards.
3. Never give your PIN to _____.
4. You _____ share your password. (must / mustn't)
5. Be careful with texts _____ ask for your PIN.

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Read & Write

A. Read the notice. *Read fast first. Then read again. Underline the time words (*when, before, after, now, last month*). Answer the questions.*

RIVERSIDE ADULT LEARNING · Class Newsletter (invented)

MY STORY SO FAR, by Tomás R. When I came to this city four years ago, I didn't know anyone. I couldn't read the bus schedule, and I was afraid to go to the doctor alone. I used to stay at home on weekends because everything was difficult.

Two years ago, my neighbor told me about the free English classes at the library. Before I started, I was very nervous. But on the first night, I met my teacher and three classmates who also worked at night. They became my friends.

The first year was a challenge. I was working at a warehouse, and I was always tired. After I finished my shift, I came to class. Sometimes I fell asleep! But I didn't stop.

Now I can do many things by myself. Last month, I was able to fill out a job application online, and I got an interview. I've made friends at work, and I'm more confident on the phone.

When I finish Level 4, I'm going to take a forklift training class. My advice? Come to class, even when you are tired. Small steps make a big change.

B. Answer the questions.

1. When he came to the city, what couldn't he do?

   _____

2. How did he hear about the classes?

   _____

3. What did he do after his shift? _____

4. What was he able to do last month?

   _____

5. What will he do when he finishes Level 4?

   _____

C. Write an email (5–8 sentences) to your teacher about your story so far: when you started, what was hard, what you can do now, and your next step, with a reason. Use *when / before / after*.

Example: Dear Mr. Hill, When I started this class in September, I couldn't understand the news on TV. The hardest part was the phone. After I practiced with my classmates, I felt more confident. Last week, I was able to call my child's school by myself. Now I can help my neighbors with forms. After I finish this class, I'll take Level 5, because I want a better job. Thank you for your help! Rosa

My email

D. Check your writing with a partner.

	Yes	Not yet
It has 5–8 sentences.	☐	☐
It has *when / before / after*.	☐	☐
It has a comma after the time part.	☐	☐
It has my next step and a reason.	☐	☐

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Exit Ticket

Name: _____ Date: _____

Answer in 3 sentences. Give a reason. Then give this page to your teacher.

Write about one change in your life.

Sentence 1: when it happened, with *When…* • *Sentence 2:* what you couldn't do before • *Sentence 3:* what you can do now, with a reason (*because*)

My answer
1.
2.
3.

For the teacher	✓	almost	not yet
3 sentences, today's grammar, a reason	☐	☐	☐

Lesson 13 (Week 14) · Task Words (optional)

This page is for you if you want it. You can skip it. Write each task word in your language, if you want.

Task word	What you do	My language
Listen.	Use your ears. Don't write yet.	
Circle.	Draw a circle around the answer.	
Check ✓.	Make a ✓ in the box.	
Write.	Write words or sentences.	
Number.	Write 1, 2, 3… to show the order.	
Match.	Find the two parts that go together.	
Work with a partner.	Work with one classmate.	
Work in a group.	Work with 2 or 3 classmates.	
Switch.	Change roles: A is B now.	
Ask a follow-up question.	Ask one more question about the answer.	
Give a reason.	Say why, with *because* or *so*.	
Compare.	Look at your partner's answers. Are they the same?	

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